

FUAD BABAIEV

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Fintech-focused Senior Project & Program Manager delivering enterprise technology and business transformation initiatives in regulated environments. Currently Senior Project Manager at MassMutual (Global Business Services, Programs & Strategic Initiatives), leading large-scale transformation and readiness initiatives across US and international offices.

Experienced in driving complex, cross-functional programs across engineering, operations, and business stakeholders — turning ambiguous initiatives into structured delivery frameworks with clear governance, risk management, and execution discipline. Background includes infrastructure modernization, cybersecurity compliance, enterprise platform implementations, and building early cryptocurrency and financial systems.

Pursuing an MS in Financial Management (AI Applications) at Boston University, deepening expertise in capital markets, financial systems, blockchain, and applied AI to bridge technology delivery with fintech innovation.

WORK EXPERIENCE

MassMutual — Global Business Services, Programs & Strategic Initiatives

Boston, MA (Hybrid)

Senior Project Manager (Contract)

July 2026 – Present

- Serve as primary point of accountability to business sponsors for planning, day-to-day execution, management, and reporting of multiple large-scale business transformation and readiness initiatives spanning US and international offices.
- Manage project scope, schedule, budget, and delivery controls across parallel workstreams, applying industry-leading project and program management practices to meet on-time and quality goals.
- Collaborate with subject matter experts to design and manage global programs — defining scope and objectives, and developing and monitoring KPIs aligned with enterprise strategic goals.
- Apply and contribute to MassMutual delivery methodologies, standards, and tools; track project performance and schedule adherence through enterprise project management software.
- Deliver consistent progress reporting on strategy, adjustments, and risks to senior executive stakeholders, influencing and engaging cross-functional teams without direct reporting authority.

City of Portland, Maine — Municipal Government, IT Infrastructure & Enterprise Systems

Portland, ME

Senior IT Project Manager

April 2023 – June 2026

- Led concurrent IT and infrastructure initiatives within a regulated municipal environment, delivering programs on schedule while aligning technology rollouts with governance and operational constraints.
- Replaced fragmented execution practices with structured delivery frameworks; built PMO guidelines from scratch by aligning PMI with ITIL and municipal government needs, improving visibility into risks, dependencies, and milestone adherence across cross-departmental initiatives.
- Designed and embedded standardized communication and governance routines into project charters, increasing accountability and execution predictability.
- Led enterprise-wide implementation of Halo ITSM for 1,500+ users, coordinating vendor engagement, cutover strategy, and stabilization to ensure controlled transition without operational disruption.
- Supported compliance frameworks impacting data access (CJIS, PII, PHI, PCI), identity controls, and incident reporting; coordinated remediation tracking for security and operational risk findings.
- Led critical cybersecurity compliance projects for the Jetport and Waterfront, adhering to US Coast Guard cybersecurity procedures; audited and enhanced IT infrastructure to ensure compliance and improve security.

Eco & Tech — White-Label Web & AI Solutions Provider

Remote

Technical Program Manager

April 2020 – September 2022

- Built and scaled delivery operations across AI, e-commerce, and enterprise software initiatives, structuring multi-stream programs in a high-growth environment.
- Led distributed cross-functional teams (20+ engineers, QA, product) across multiple time zones, establishing execution discipline and predictable release cycles.
- Introduced portfolio-level visibility into capacity, prioritization, and delivery risk, improving allocation of engineering resources across parallel initiatives.
- Intervened in underperforming projects, realigned scope and sequencing, and stabilized delivery to protect client relationships and revenue streams.
- Hired and built the engineering organization from the ground up, supporting presales and expanding partnerships with EU and US agencies to increase deal flow and service reach.

Yelk — E-commerce & Digital Product Development Agency

Remote

Project Manager (E-commerce)

April 2018 – March 2020

- Delivered multiple client-facing web and e-commerce projects, structuring execution through defined sprint cycles, scope control, and stakeholder alignment.
- Professionalized internal collaboration by introducing Jira, Confluence, and Slack as standardized delivery infrastructure, increasing transparency and reducing cross-team friction.
- Led payment gateway integrations (Stripe, PayPal, Klarna), coordinating directly with vendors to resolve API, compliance, and transaction-flow issues while protecting client delivery timelines.

UkrExchange — Cryptocurrency Exchange (BTC Trading Platform)

Co-Founder & Product Manager

February 2013 – December 2014

- Co-founded and launched an early BTC-to-fiat exchange, building expertise in crypto infrastructure, exchange mechanics, and transactional system design in a nascent market.
- Owned end-to-end platform operations; transitioned from manual trade handling to automated processing flows, increasing execution speed and reliability.
- Integrated local banking APIs to enable automated fiat settlement flows, significantly reducing transaction processing time and increasing platform reliability.

Various Ventures

Entrepreneur & Project Consultant

March 2012 – March 2022

- Led development of a \$500K+ cryptocurrency mining infrastructure project — vendor sourcing, architecture design, construction coordination, and real-time operational dashboards tracking minute-level revenue and expenses.
- Founded and scaled a lounge café business; introduced Scrum-based management and a KPI-driven incentive system that doubled revenue within 6 months.
- Founded and operated an aviation-focused travel agency and an international automotive sourcing and logistics business (US insurance auctions → Ukraine), building teams, SOPs, and multi-channel sales operations.

EDUCATION

Boston University — MS in Financial Management (AI Applications)

Boston, MA
2025 – 2027

Selected coursework: Corporate Finance, Financial Analysis, Applied AI for Business, AI Agents and Automation, Data-Driven Decision Making, Blockchain, financial risk modeling, capital markets structures.

Ulster University — Postgraduate Diploma, Global Capital Markets (Fintech Management)

Dublin, Ireland
2022 – 2023

Selected coursework: Financial Theory & Markets, Equities & Derivatives, Investment Funds & Taxation, Financial Econometric Modeling.

National Law Academy of Ukraine — LLB & LLM (International Law)

Kharkiv, Ukraine
2008 – 2013

CERTIFICATIONS

Project Management Professional (PMP) • SAFe Agilist • Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO) • Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) • PRINCE2 • Blockchain for Business and Finance

SKILLS

Program & Delivery Management

Enterprise program delivery, Agile/Scrum, SAFe, ITIL, SDLC governance, roadmap planning, risk & issue management, delivery forecasting, release planning, program reporting, KPI development & monitoring

Stakeholder & Governance Management

Executive communication, cross-functional leadership, stakeholder alignment, governance frameworks, steering committee reporting, vendor & partner management, negotiation, change management, influencing without authority

Financial Systems & Fintech

Financial systems delivery, blockchain fundamentals, digital assets ecosystems, crypto exchange workflows, KYC/AML fundamentals, regulatory compliance environments, security-focused program delivery

Technical & Analytical Tools

Jira, Confluence, SQL, Power BI, Python, Figma, Miro, HaloITSM, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Workspace, documentation & reporting automation, APIs & system integrations, DEV/UAT/PROD lifecycle coordination, cloud-hosted environments